

Executive-brief writing: clear decisions from R&D evidence

The **executive-brief-writing** skill helps an agent turn R&D evidence into a concise explanation, decision brief or recommendation for a mostly nontechnical sponsor. It brings the answer and consequences forward while preserving the uncertainty that could change a decision. Specialist detail can sit in an appendix or linked reference. [1]

What changes in the writing

The author starts with the sponsor's question and selects the support needed to answer it. After assembling the brief, an editorial pass locates reading problems such as stacked abstractions or an unexplained connection. Edits vary pace where the argument calls for it and recheck changed meaning against sources. The skill does not prescribe a new tone every sentence or use sentence-length scores as a quality target. [1]; [2]

A short or low-risk brief can use one manuscript and concise evidence notes. When sources change or exports recur, the managed path adds a reader brief, plan and evidence records to track reviews. A full dependency graph tracks relationships for substantial coordination; technical subject matter alone does not require it. One lead author keeps responsibility for the complete brief. [1]

What the evidence supports

A bounded comparison included two executive briefs and two technical papers. Initial executive drafts needed clearer release scope and evidence allocation. After clarification and a genuine source correction, final independent reviewers found no material factual defect; fresh readers recovered the message and limits. One executive case used direct drafting, the other managed production with compact planning. These were agent-based reviews and reader checks, not tests with intended human readers. These observations establish feasibility for that task, without establishing average quality or savings. [3]; [4]

The helper suite passed 64 checks of structure and freshness. Those checks do not establish recommendation truth. The final wording retained the direct path after the comparison; that wording change was not a separate author trial. The comparison delivered Markdown and did not test PDF appearance. The prose-editing revision and this PDF are subsequent demonstrations, not additions to that trial. [5]; [3]; [2]

A proportionate first use

Try it on the next reviewed R&D update using an existing evidence packet and the sponsor's question. Start direct; add managed controls when changing evidence warrants them. Before circulation, verify material claims, ask a fresh reader to explain the message and caveats, and inspect the rendered pages. This proposed first use commits no budget or staffing. Whether the new editorial pass improves reading across topics and sponsors remains untested. [1]; [6]; [2]

Evidence notes

Local sources are archived with this brief. Instructions establish intended behavior; evaluation records establish bounded observations. These related project artifacts are not independent studies.

References

- [1] Finalized executive-brief-writing skill. Local project record, archived as sources/S01-SKILL.md.
- [2] Located prose-editing contract. Local instruction revision, archived as sources/S06-human-writing.md.
- [3] Writing workflow evaluation and limitations. Local project record, archived as sources/S03-RESULTS.md.
- [4] Final document review and control outcomes. Local project record, archived as sources/S04-final-summary.json.
- [5] Helper regression summary. Local project record, archived as sources/S05-summary.json.
- [6] Executive reading and review contract. Local project record, archived as sources/S02-writing-and-figures.md.